



MONTHLY UPDATE

Sao Tome and Principe: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 11 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · DPI · CAPACITY

Summary of the month

Eight rows moved between 1 July and 11 August 2026. The National Electoral Commission opened public consultation on a provisional voter roll after finding [the automatic civil-registry derivation had missed 1,860 eligible voters](#) — the clearest instance yet of a system inheriting the flaws of the register it was built from. The [Cadastral Social Único's coverage figure](#) — [about 12,500 households, roughly a quarter of the population](#) — [was published for the first time](#), with the agency itself taking care to state that registration is not a poverty count. AGER convened the country's first Internet Governance Forum, and AUDA-NEPAD launched its island-economies programme covering STP among seven states. A regional data-governance workshop moved forward the national adoption process for the African Union's Data Policy Framework, and EMAE's management-information-system tender was extended with no further procurement detail disclosed. UNICEF opened a tender for school ICT equipment, its contract value left to bidders to price.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

[A Data Governance Capacity Building Workshop ran 9–10 July 2026](#), led by the D4D Hub with GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD and KICTANET, on national adoption of the AU Data Policy Framework; translation into policy or institutional reform remains the stated goal, not yet delivered. [AUDA-NEPAD launched its Programme for African Developing Island Economies at the AU's STC Ministerial Segment in Abidjan on 24 July](#), adopting a ministerial communiqué covering STP among seven island states on a 2026–2031 roadmap naming digital transformation, AI and automation, and the knowledge economy among its accelerators, with partners including Korea, the AfDB, the regional economic communities and the Indian Ocean Commission.

Data protection

A further agreement between the two jurisdictions on [exchanging information to combat money laundering is to be signed](#). It is the second instrument with the same counterpart and the base holds no signature date or text for it.

Regional collaboration

São Tomé and Príncipe was one of six countries at the [second Lusophone Africa data governance workshop, held in Luanda from 15 to 17 June with an implementation focus](#) — [data centres, cloud, interoperability, digital public infrastructure and institutional governance](#). No São Toméan national content from the workshop is detailed, so what the country took from it is not established.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

[AGER convened the first Fórum de Governança da Internet \(FGI STP\) on 28–30 July 2026](#), at Casa Cacao, opened by the Prime Minister, with tracks covering digital trust, service-delivery infrastructure, regulation, privacy and data protection, and AI, framed under the theme of connectivity as a pillar for digital inclusion. It is the regulator's own convening rather than a government ministry's, and the first time São Tomé and Príncipe has run a national forum of this kind. No outcome document or date for a second edition was published.

Finance

New investments

UNICEF's tender for school ICT equipment, opened 30 July 2026 against grant SC220341, is the month's only new financing activity in this section; no contract value was stated, since bidders price the supply themselves, and the tender does not disclose the total size of the grant it draws on.

DPI

Registries

[The National Electoral Commission opened a 1–8 August 2026 public-consultation window](#) on a provisional roll of 146,510 registered voters, ahead of the 27 September elections, after finding the automatically-compiled roll had omitted 1,860 eligible voters through a process failure — alongside 1,976 newly-eligible 18-year-olds added in the ordinary course. Address and polling-station changes can only be made in person or via WhatsApp; there is no online self-service channel, a gap the roll's own automatic-derivation design has not closed. [The Direção da Proteção Social reported the Cadastro Social Único covered about 12,500 households](#), roughly a quarter of the population, and stated explicitly that registration does not equal a poverty diagnosis — a distinction the agency drew unprompted, suggesting the figure was already being read the other way in public discussion. This update follows a mass population-registration exercise the government ran in January and February 2026, though no source held gives that earlier exercise's own separate coverage figure for a direct year-on-year comparison against it.

Sectoral management information systems

[AFAP extended the deadline of tender ref. 45-G](#) on 7 August 2026 for supply, installation, training and commissioning of a new management-information system for EMAE, the state water and electricity utility. The original terms, contract value and new deadline are not stated in the source held — a scanned procurement notice with no text layer, so only the notice's own headline could be read for this pass.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The month's government-systems movement is hardware. A UN agency [handed computing equipment to the tax directorate under an EU-funded regional programme, to modernise tax administration and the handling of fiscal data](#). No value is stated for the equipment and no delivery schedule accompanies it, so what the base holds is a donation and an intention rather than a system with a capability attached.

Capacity

Literacy

UNICEF's São Tomé office opened a tender ([RFQ_03/2026, closing 12 August](#)) for 80 tablets and 90 all-in-one desktop computers to reinforce technology in school ICT rooms, against grant SC220341 under the National Digital Learning Programme (PNAD), with delivery preferred by the second week of September 2026. No contract value was stated in the tender notice, since bidders price the supply themselves.

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This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.